

Taufiq Syed *Data Scientist*

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Synopsis

Data Scientist with strong hands-on experience in large language models and transformer-based systems, including fine-tuning / preference tuning, open-source LLMs, and evaluating LLMs.

Solid understanding of the full ML workflow, from data preparation and modeling to evaluation and deployment. Brings practical depth from applied research while focusing on building reliable, usable ML systems in product-driven environments.

Awards

Secured 2nd in Noon Cake Product Management Hackathon | 2025 [🔗](#)

Secured 2nd in SoftwareAG GITECH Future Disruptors Competition | 2023 [🔗](#)

Placed 1st in AUS Programming Contest | 2022

Secured 2nd in Abu Dhabi University STEM Programming Contest | 2022

Secured 2nd in "AUS Tech-centric Hackathon" | 2022

Participated in Gulf Programming Contest (5th out of 30 teams) | 2022

Skills

Backend Development: Node.js, Django, Docker, Linux, Bash, SQL, MongoDB, NoSQL, WebSockets

Large Language Models: Hugging Face, LangChain, Fine-tuning, NLP, Transformers

Source Control: Git, GitHub, GitLab, CI/CD

Front-end Development: React, Next.js, Angular, Flutter, React Native, HTML, CSS

UX/UI: User stories, Wireframing, Mock-ups, Figma

Machine Learning & Data Science: Regression, Classification, Time-Series Forecasting, Exploratory Data Analysis (EDA), TensorFlow, PyTorch, Scikit-learn, Pandas, NumPy, PySpark, Gradient Boosting

Data & Visualization: SQL, PostgreSQL, Data Modeling, Matplotlib, Seaborn

AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner [🔗](#)

Coursera Deep Learning Specialization [🔗](#)

Languages

Python • C++ • TypeScript • JavaScript • Java • MATLAB • R • Dart • Flutter • SQL

Soft Skills

Leadership • Creativity • Divergent thinking • Initiative • Communication • Adaptability • Cross-functional communication • Product thinking • Feature-ownership

Education

American University of Sharjah

BS Computer Science (Minor in Data Science)

09/2021 – 06/2025

Courses: Neural Networks, Artificial Intelligence, Data Mining, Stochastic Systems, Data Science, Recommendation Systems, Database Systems

Professional Experience

Full-Stack Developer

Belsons Technologies (Land Sterling Group) [🔗](#)

08/2025 – Present | Dubai, UAE

- Extended a proprietary ERP platform with data-driven modules, focusing on scalability, clean architecture, and long-term maintainability.
- Collaborated with stakeholders to translate business requirements into technical solutions, prioritizing user and operational impact.
- Implemented automated testing within CI workflows to ensure production reliability.

Software Engineering Intern

Belsons Technologies (Land Sterling Group) [🔗](#)

07/2024 – 08/2024 | Dubai, UAE

- Conducted statistical market analysis on real estate data and generated AI-driven property reports using GPT-4.
- Performed exploratory data analysis on real-world DLD property data to identify trends and support forecasting insights.

Software Engineering Intern

ILM UX Ltd. [🔗](#)

06/2022 – 09/2022 | Mumbai, India

- Contributed automated tests as part of a CI/CD pipeline to improve deployment quality
- Developed a real-time internal chat application using WebSockets

Projects

Full-Stack Reddit Clone [🔗](#)

Personal

- Built a full-stack web application using React, Next.js, Node.js, and PostgreSQL
- Implemented JWT-based authentication and REST APIs
- Focused on clean architecture, scalability, and maintainable code

Attendance & Event App

AUS College of Engineering

- Designed backend APIs using Node.js to support mobile clients
- Implemented offline caching and Cloud Messaging notification workflows

Generation of High-Level Music Structures

American University of Sharjah - COE 476

- Processed music dataset into music-prompt pairs with extracted structural information, and fine-tuned the MusicGen transformer using a LoRA adaptor.
 - Involved dataset preprocessing, feature extraction, model evaluation, and performance benchmarking.
- [CLAP LAION FAD: 0.9959; Overall Quality: 70.48/100]

Research

Published Research (Co-Authorship)

- A Smartphone-Based Application for Crop Irrigation Estimation in Selected South and Southeast Asia Countries – MDPI, 2026 [🔗](#)
- Generative AI for Early Grade Story Generation Using a Self-Reflective Approach – IEEE, 2025 [🔗](#)
- Tailored Tales: Enhancing Children's Reading Comprehension with Preference-Tuned Automatic Story Generation – IEEE, 2025 [🔗](#)
- Can GPT-4 Aid in Detecting Ambiguities, Inconsistencies, and Incompleteness in Requirements Analysis? A Comprehensive Case Study – IEEE Access, 2024 [🔗](#)
- Once Upon a GPT-4: Enhancing Diversity in Automated Reading Comprehension Story Generation with Classic Tales – IEEE, 2024 [🔗](#)

Extracurriculars

President | Open Source Club [🔗](#)

American University of Sharjah | 2023-2024

Led and delivered hands-on workshops on Node.js, React, Git, and software engineering best practices

Activities Coordinator | Tech-Entrepreneurship Club [🔗](#)

American University of Sharjah | 2023 - 2024

Led a 5-part workshop series on cross-platform mobile development and backend integration for beginners